

Word family: **effort / efforts / effortless / effortlessly**

Base word: effort

Part of speech: mainly **noun**

Related forms:

* **effort** (n.) — 努力；付出；嘗試；共同工作

* **efforts** (plural n.) — 各種努力；多次嘗試

* **effortless** (adj.) — 不費力的；看起來毫不費力的

* **effortlessly** (adv.) — 毫不費力地；輕鬆地

* **effortful** (adj.) — 需要努力的；費力的（較正式 / 較少見）

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **make an effort**

* **make every effort**

* **put effort into**

* **require effort**

* **take effort**

* **with effort**

* **without effort**

* **physical effort**

* **mental effort**

* **conscious effort**

* **extra effort**

* **equal effort**

* **uneven effort**

* **a great deal of effort**

* **an effort to do something**

* **in an effort to**

* **joint effort**

* **team effort**

* **collective effort**

* **relief effort**

* **rescue effort**

* **war effort**

* **good effort**

* **effortless performance**

Meaning in this passage

> Many workers associate it with wasted time, **uneven effort** and unnecessary conflict.

and later:

> One major challenge of group work is the unequal distribution of **effort**.

Here, **effort** means:

the amount of work, energy, and commitment that each person puts into the group task — 努力；付出

The problem is that some employees work very hard while others contribute much less.

中文翻譯：

很多員工會把團隊合作和浪費時間、**付出不均**以及不必要的衝突聯想在一起。

So here:

effort = 為完成工作而投入的時間、精力和心力

1. **effort (努力；付出) — 努力；心力；付出**

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> Workers often complain about **uneven effort** in group work.

員工經常抱怨團隊合作中出現**付出不均**。

Practice 2

> Everyone should put in the same level of **effort**.

每個人都應該投入相若程度的**努力**。

Practice 3

> The project required a great deal of **effort**.

這個項目需要付出大量**心力**。

MCQ-ready definition:

effort = 為完成某件事而投入的體力、精神、時間或心力

2. **put effort into something — 在某事上投入努力**

Practice 1

> She **put a lot of effort into the presentation**.

她在簡報上**投入了很多心力**。

Practice 2

> If everyone **puts equal effort into the project**, resentment is less likely.

如果每個人在項目上都**付出相若的努力**，就較少出現不滿。

MCQ-ready definition:

put effort into X = 為做好 X 而投入時間、精力和心力

3. **put in effort — 付出努力**

Practice 1

> Some members simply did not **put in enough effort**.

有些成員根本沒有**付出足夠努力**。

Practice 2

> You will improve if you **put in the effort**.

只要你肯**下功夫**，就會進步。

MCQ-ready definition:

put in effort = 實際投入所需的努力

4. **make an effort — 努力一下；作出努力**

A major fixed expression.

Practice 1

> Everyone should **make an effort to communicate clearly**.

每個人都應該**努力清楚溝通**。

Practice 2

> He made an **effort to include quieter members**.

他**努力讓較安靜的成員參與其中**。

MCQ-ready definition:

make an effort = 有意識地嘗試做好某事，即使需要付出額外心力

5. **make an effort to do something — 努力做某事**

Practice 1

> I made an **effort to arrive on time**.

我**努力準時到達**。

Practice 2

> Managers should make an **effort to recognise individual contributions**.

管理人員應**努力肯定每個人的貢獻**。

MCQ-ready definition:

make an effort to do X = 刻意付出努力去完成 X

6. **make every effort — 盡一切努力**

Practice 1

> We will **make every effort** to finish on time.

我們會**盡一切努力**準時完成。

Practice 2

> The team made **every effort to resolve the conflict**.

團隊**盡力**解決衝突。

MCQ-ready definition:

make every effort = 盡可能採取所有合理方法去達成目標

7. **require effort — 需要努力**

Practice 1

> Good teamwork **requires effort** from everyone.

良好的團隊合作需要每個人**付出努力**。

Practice 2

> Building trust takes time and **requires effort**.

建立信任需要時間，也需要**付出心力**。

MCQ-ready definition:

require effort = 某件事不能自動完成，需要投入精力才能做到

8. **take effort — 需要花力氣 / 心力**

Practice 1

> Staying calm under pressure **takes effort**.

在壓力下保持冷靜**需要下功夫**。

Practice 2

> Good communication **takes effort**.

良好溝通**需要用心經營**。

MCQ-ready definition:

take effort = 完成或維持某件事需要投入心力

9. **physical effort — 體力；身體上的努力**

Practice 1

> Moving the equipment required considerable **physical effort**.

搬動設備需要相當大的**體力**。

Practice 2

> Climbing the hill took a lot of **physical effort**.

爬上山坡耗費了很多**體力**。

MCQ-ready definition:

physical effort = 身體為完成動作而付出的力量和能量

10. **mental effort** — 腦力；精神上的努力

Practice 1

> Solving a complex problem requires **mental effort**.

解決複雜問題需要大量**腦力**。

Practice 2

> Staying focused for hours takes considerable **mental effort**.

連續數小時保持專注需要相當大的**精神力量**。

MCQ-ready definition:

mental effort = 思考、專注、理解或控制自己時所投入的精神力量

11. **conscious effort** — 有意識的努力；刻意努力

Practice 1

> Good listening sometimes requires a **conscious effort**.

好好聆聽有時需要**刻意努力**。

Practice 2

> She made a **conscious effort** not to dominate the discussion.

她**刻意提醒自己**不要主導整場討論。

MCQ-ready definition:

conscious effort = 有意識、有目的地刻意做出的努力

12. **extra effort** — 額外努力

Practice 1

> She put in **extra effort** to help the group.

她為幫助小組**額外**付出了努力。

Practice 2

> The task required some **extra effort**.

這項工作需要多花一點**心力**。

MCQ-ready definition:

extra effort = 超出一般或基本要求而額外投入的努力

13. **uneven effort** — 付出不均

This is the exact collocation used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> **Uneven effort** can create resentment within a team.

付出不均會在團隊內造成不滿。

Practice 2

> The project suffered because of **uneven effort among team members**.

由於組員之間**付出不平均**，項目受到影響。

MCQ-ready definition:

****uneven effort = 不同成員投入的工作量和心力明顯不相等****

14. ****equal effort — 相等 / 相若的付出****

Practice 1

> Group work feels fairer when everyone makes an ****equal effort****.

當每個人都作出****相若的付出****時，團隊合作會感覺更公平。

Practice 2

> The members did not contribute ****equal effort****.

成員沒有付出****同等程度的努力****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****equal effort = 各方投入大致相等程度的工作和精力****

15. ****a great deal of effort — 大量努力****

Practice 1

> The presentation took a ****great deal of effort****.

準備這個簡報花了****大量心力****。

Practice 2

> Maintaining cooperation requires a ****great deal of effort****.

維持合作需要****付出很多努力****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****a great deal of effort = 非常大量的時間、精力或心力投入****

16. ****with effort — 費力地；經過努力****

Practice 1

> He lifted the box **with effort**.

他**很費力地**把箱子抬起來。

Practice 2

> She managed, **with some effort**, to remain calm.

她**費了一番功夫**才保持冷靜。

MCQ-ready definition:

with effort = 需要付出明顯力量或心力才能做到

17. **without effort** — 毫不費力地

Practice 1

> The door opened **without effort**.

這道門**毫不費力**便打開了。

Practice 2

> Real teamwork does not happen **without effort**.

真正的團隊合作不會**不用付出**便自然出現。

MCQ-ready definition:

without effort = 不需要明顯的力量、時間或心力

18. **effort** (嘗試) — 嘗試 ; 努力行動

A second important sense.

Here, **an effort** can refer to **a particular attempt to achieve something**, not merely the amount of energy used.

Practice 1

> His first **effort** failed.

他的第一次**嘗試**失敗了。

Practice 2

> The team made another **effort** to solve the problem.

團隊再次**嘗試**解決問題。

MCQ-ready definition:

an effort = 為達成某個目標而作出的一次具體嘗試

19. **an effort to do something** — 為做某事而作出的努力 / 嘗試

Practice 1

> The company made an **effort to improve communication**.

公司**努力改善溝通**。

Practice 2

> In an **effort to reduce conflict**, the manager changed the meeting format.

為了**減少衝突**，經理改變了會議形式。

MCQ-ready definition:

an effort to do X = 以達成 X 為目的的具體行動或嘗試

20. **in an effort to** — 為了；試圖

A very common formal linking phrase.

Practice 1

> The team introduced weekly meetings **in an effort to improve communication**.

團隊引入每週會議，**以改善溝通**。

Practice 2

> Managers clarified roles **in an effort to reduce confusion**.

管理人員釐清各人角色，**希望減少混亂**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****in an effort to do X = 為了嘗試達成 X 而採取某個行動****

21. ****efforts (多項 / 持續的努力) — 各種努力 ; 持續付出****

Practice 1

> Their ****efforts**** eventually paid off.

他們的****努力****最終得到回報。

Practice 2

> We appreciate your ****efforts to improve the system****.

我們很感謝你為改善系統所作的****努力****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****efforts = 為達成某個目標而作出的一連串行動和嘗試****

22. ****joint effort — 共同努力****

Practice 1

> The project was a ****joint effort**** between several departments.

這個項目是數個部門****共同努力的成果****。

Practice 2

> Solving the problem will require a ****joint effort****.

解決這個問題需要大家****共同努力****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****joint effort = 兩個或以上的人 / 團體一起付出的努力****

23. ****team effort — 團隊共同努力 ; 團隊成果****

Practice 1

> The successful presentation was a **team effort**.

這次成功的簡報是**全體團隊共同努力的成果**。

Practice 2

> Good teamwork should feel like a genuine **team effort**.

好的團隊合作應該讓人感到是一次真正的**共同合作**。

MCQ-ready definition:

team effort = 由整個團隊共同工作和付出而完成的事情

24. **collective effort** — 集體努力

Practice 1

> Improving workplace culture requires **collective effort**.

改善職場文化需要**集體努力**。

Practice 2

> The outcome was achieved through **collective effort**.

這個成果是透過**大家共同努力**取得的。

MCQ-ready definition:

collective effort = 一群人共同投入力量去達成同一目標

25. **relief effort** — 救援 / 賑災工作

Here **effort** means an organized operation involving many people.

Practice 1

> Volunteers joined the **relief effort** after the disaster.

災難後，義工加入了**賑災工作**。

Practice 2

> International organisations supported the **relief effort**.

國際組織支援了**救援行動**。

MCQ-ready definition:

relief effort = 為幫助受災人士而組織的大型救援行動

26. **rescue effort — 救援行動**

Practice 1

> Bad weather delayed the **rescue effort**.

惡劣天氣延誤了**救援行動**。

Practice 2

> Hundreds of people took part in the **rescue effort**.

數百人參與了**救援工作**。

MCQ-ready definition:

rescue effort = 為救出陷於危險中的人而展開的組織性行動

27. **war effort — 戰時總動員；戰爭努力**

An established historical expression.

Practice 1

> Factories were redirected to support the **war effort**.

工廠轉為支援**戰時生產和戰爭需要**。

Practice 2

> Civilians also contributed to the **war effort**.

平民也為**戰時總動員**作出貢獻。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****war effort = 一個國家為進行戰爭而投入的整體人力、資源和活動****

28. ****good effort — 做得不錯；很好的嘗試****

Often used as encouragement.

Practice 1

> You didn't win, but it was a ****good effort****.

你雖然沒有勝出，但已經是一次****很不錯的努力 / 嘗試****。

Practice 2

> ****Good effort****—your argument is much clearer now.

****做得不錯****，你的論點現在清楚多了。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****good effort = 對某人的認真嘗試或付出表示肯定和鼓勵****

29. ****effortless — 毫不費力的；輕鬆自然的****

Practice 1

> She made the presentation look ****effortless****.

她令這次簡報看起來****毫不費力****。

Practice 2

> His movements looked completely ****effortless****.

他的動作看起來完全****輕鬆自然****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****effortless = 看起來不需要明顯努力便能做到的****

30. ****effortlessly — 毫不費力地；輕鬆地****

Practice 1

> She moved **effortlessly** between different tasks.

她**輕鬆地**在不同任務之間切換。

Practice 2

> The speaker answered the questions **effortlessly**.

講者**從容不迫地**回答問題。

MCQ-ready definition:

effortlessly = 看起來幾乎不用花力氣或心力地

31. **effortful** — 費力的；需要刻意努力的

A real modern word, especially in psychology, education, and cognitive science, though much less common than **effortless**.

Practice 1

> Careful reasoning can be mentally **effortful**.

仔細推理可能相當**費腦力**。

Practice 2

> At first, the new habit felt **effortful**.

起初，這個新習慣感覺**需要刻意下很多功夫**。

MCQ-ready definition:

effortful = 需要明顯精神或身體努力才能完成的

Important distinction 1: **effort** vs **work**

work

the activity or job itself.

effort

the energy and determination put into it.

> I have a lot of work.

> 我有很多工作。

> I put a lot of effort into the work.

> 我在這份工作上**投入很多心力**。

You can have a lot of work but put in little effort.

Important distinction 2: **effort vs energy**

energy

capacity or strength to act.

effort

the actual use of that energy toward a goal.

> I have no energy today.

> 我今天沒有精神。

> The task requires a lot of effort.

> 這項任務需要很多努力。

Important distinction 3: **effort vs attempt**

attempt

focuses on **trying to do something**, especially whether you succeed.

effort

can focus on either:

* how much energy you put in, or

* a deliberate attempt.

> His first attempt failed.

> 他的第一次嘗試失敗。

> He put a lot of effort into it.

> 他投入了很多心力。

So **effort** is broader.

Important distinction 4: **effort vs exertion**

effort

very broad: physical or mental.

exertion

especially physical or intense use of strength.

> mental effort

> 腦力

> physical exertion

> 體力消耗

Exertion is usually more formal.

Important distinction 5: **effort vs contribution**

Very relevant to your passage.

effort

how much work/energy someone puts in.

contribution

what they actually add to the group's result.

Someone can put in a great deal of effort but still make a relatively small contribution if the work is ineffective.

Important distinction 6: **effort vs performance**

effort

input.

performance

how well someone actually performs.

A person can show:

- * high effort + weak performance,
- * low effort + strong performance.

The concepts must not be merged.

Important distinction 7: **make an effort vs try**

They overlap strongly.

try

very general.

make an effort

often emphasizes deliberate extra energy or care.

> Try to listen.

> 試着聽。

> Make an effort to listen.

> **用心一點去聽。**

The latter can sound stronger.

Important distinction 8: **put effort into vs make an effort**

put effort into X

emphasizes the **amount of energy invested in X**.

make an effort to do X

emphasizes a deliberate attempt.

> She put a lot of effort into the report.

> 她在報告上花了很多心力。

> She made an effort to finish the report early.

> 她努力提早完成報告。

Important distinction 9: **effort countable vs uncountable**

Uncountable:

amount of work/energy.

> It takes a lot of **effort**.

需要很多努力。

Countable:

a particular attempt or organized action.

> We made several **efforts** to contact him.

我們曾多次**嘗試**聯絡他。

This is an important grammar distinction.

Important distinction 10: **efforts plural often means actions**

> Her efforts were successful.

usually means:

她所作出的一連串努力 / 行動成功了

not simply a measurable quantity of energy.

Important distinction 11: **effortless** does not necessarily mean no effort was actually involved

A professional may make something look:

> **effortless**

even though years of training were required.

So:

effortless = appears easy / requires little apparent effort

It does not always mean zero preparation.

Important distinction 12: **good effort**

This may praise the attempt even if the outcome was unsuccessful.

So:

> good effort $\neq$ successful result

This makes **effort** especially useful when separating **input** from **outcome**.

Important distinction 13: **uneven effort** vs **unequal contribution**

These overlap but are not identical.

uneven effort

different people are trying/working at very different levels.

unequal contribution

the amount or value actually added by each person differs.

In your passage, both are closely connected because some members **shoulder most of the burden** while others contribute very little.

Important distinction 14: **joint effort vs teamwork**

teamwork

the broader process/skill of working together.

joint effort

one particular goal achieved by several parties working together.

> Teamwork is important.

> 團隊合作很重要。

> The report was a joint effort.

> 這份報告是大家共同完成的。

Family-extension note

Effort has a coherent core:

energy, work, or determination directed toward accomplishing something

From that core come several useful branches:

1. **amount of energy/work**

* put in effort

* mental effort

* physical effort

2. **deliberate attempt**

* make an effort

* an effort to improve

3. **multiple attempts/actions**

* efforts to solve the problem

4. **collective action**

* joint effort

* team effort

5. **organized large-scale operation**

- * relief effort
- * rescue effort
- * war effort

6. **evaluation/encouragement**

- * good effort

7. **ease/difficulty family**

- * effortless
- * effortlessly
- * effortful

For your passage, the exact meaning is:

effort = the amount of work, time, energy, and commitment each team member puts into the shared task

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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effort	努力；付出	energy/work invested
put effort into X	在 X 上投入心力	investment
put in effort	付出努力	work input
make an effort	作出努力	deliberate attempt
make every effort	盡一切努力	maximum attempt
require effort	需要努力	needs input
physical effort	體力	physical exertion
mental effort	腦力；精神努力	cognitive input
conscious effort	刻意努力	deliberate control
extra effort	額外努力	beyond normal
uneven effort	付出不均	unequal input
equal effort	相若的付出	equal input
with effort	費力地	difficulty
an effort (attempt)	一次嘗試	attempt
an effort to X	為 X 作出的努力	purposeful attempt
in an effort to	為了；試圖	purpose
efforts	各種 / 多次努力	repeated actions
joint effort	共同努力	shared action
team effort	團隊共同努力	team contribution

collective effort	集體努力	group action	
relief effort	賑災工作	organized operation	
rescue effort	救援行動	organized rescue	
war effort	戰時總動員	national organized effort	
good effort	做得不錯；好的嘗試	encouragement	
effortless	毫不費力的	appears easy	
effortlessly	輕鬆地	without apparent effort	
effortful	費力的	requires effort	

For your original passage

> Many workers associate it with wasted time, **uneven effort** and unnecessary conflict.

and:

> One major challenge of group work is the unequal distribution of **effort**.

Here:

effort = 每個組員為共同工作投入多少時間、精力、心力和認真程度

The problem is essentially:

> some employees **put in a lot of effort**

> while others **put in very little**

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 很多員工會把團隊合作和浪費時間、**付出不均**以及不必要的衝突聯想在一起。

The cleanest contrast is:

> **work** = 要做的工作本身

> **effort** = **你為工作投入多少心力**

> **contribution** = 你實際為團隊加入了多少成果或價值

> **performance** = 你最終做得有多好

For this passage, **uneven effort** is especially precise because the complaint is not simply that team members have different jobs—it is that **some people work much harder than others while receiving the same group benefit**.